

Agentic AI, in 2026: Four predictions for business leaders

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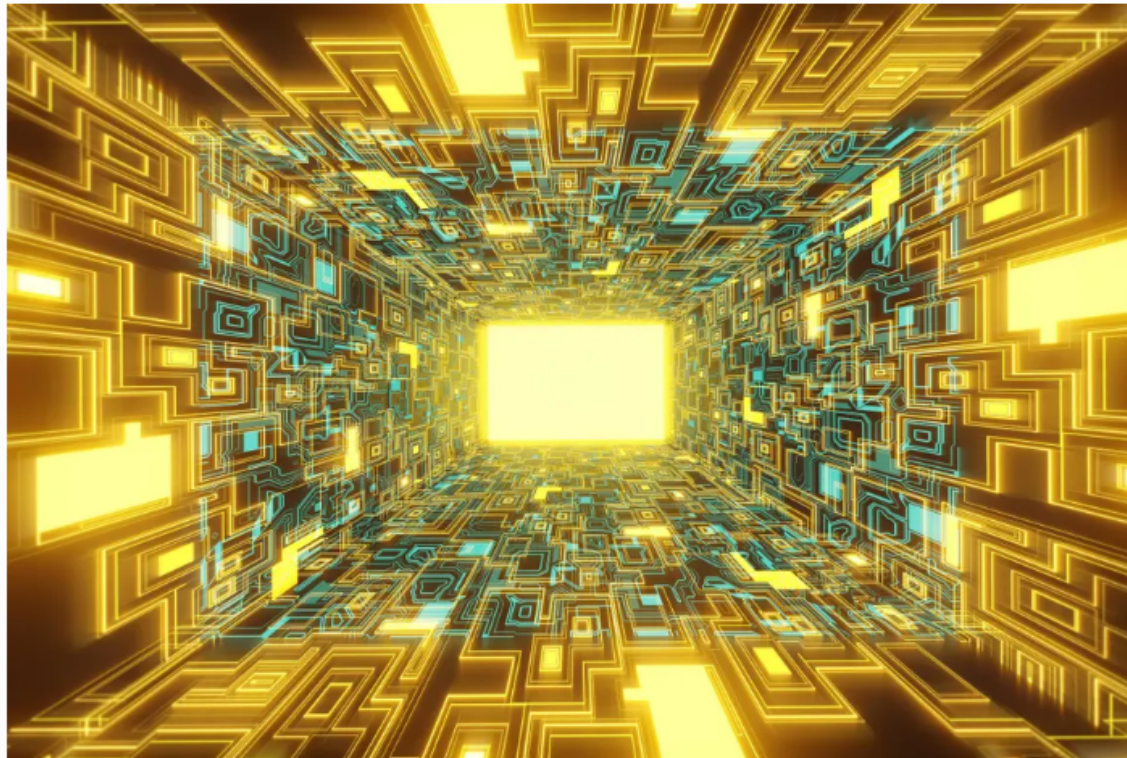
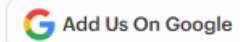
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Agentic AI In 2026: Four Predictions For Business Leaders

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The important questions for leaders as we enter a new stage of agentic AI are: What does it look like to work alongside AI agents? How can leaders deploy agents effectively and responsibly?

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- <https://www.forbes.com/sites/larryenglish/2026/01/13/agent-ai-in-2026-four-predictions-for-business-leaders/>

Main Findings

- The article explains that **agentic AI (AI agents)** represents the next major stage of artificial intelligence, moving beyond simple tools into systems that can act autonomously to complete tasks. These AI agents are capable of reasoning, planning actions, and interacting with software systems or data to accomplish goals with minimal human input.
- The author predicts that in 2026 AI agents will move from experimental technology into **enterprise infrastructure used across many business functions**. Surveys show that many organizations are already experimenting with AI agents, and a growing number are beginning to scale their use across workflows.
- The article presents four main predictions:
 - AI agents will become integrated into everyday business processes.
 - Organizations will rely on AI agents to automate complex workflows.
 - Businesses will need governance and responsible AI practices to manage risks.
 - Companies that adopt AI agents early will gain competitive advantages through productivity and innovation.
- Overall, the article argues that AI agents will fundamentally change how organizations operate by enabling automation of complex decision-making tasks.

Broader Implications for Society

- The rise of AI agents could significantly impact society by transforming how work is performed. AI agents may automate many repetitive tasks, allowing workers to focus on higher-level problem solving and strategic activities. This could increase productivity across many industries while also changing workforce skills and job roles.
- However, the technology also raises concerns about **responsible AI use, governance, and ethical considerations**. Organizations must ensure transparency, accountability, and proper oversight when deploying autonomous systems. As AI agents become more capable, society will need new frameworks to manage their risks while maximizing their benefits.

Relevance and Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

- Although the article focuses primarily on business operations, AI agents could also influence the **construction industry**. In construction and engineering, AI agents could assist with project planning, cost estimation, design analysis, and scheduling. For example, AI agents could analyze BIM models, identify design conflicts, optimize material usage, and automatically generate reports for project managers.
- AI agents could also help automate coordination tasks across large projects by monitoring data from design models, schedules, and jobsite progress. This could improve efficiency, reduce delays, and support better decision-making in complex construction projects. As the construction industry continues to adopt digital technologies like BIM and AI, autonomous AI agents may become valuable tools for managing project data and improving productivity.